



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:			Inspection of Mobile Plant and Equipment		

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Before you use any plant or equipment it is vital that it is inspected and any faults found are recorded and reported. Operators of plant should have access to the machine's manual / handbook for information on how to maintain the vehicle.

Inspections must cover the following: -

- The condition of the vehicle must be satisfactory, doors, guards, windows, mirrors, etc.
- The wheels must be inspected to ensure that they are secured to the machine and the tyres are inflated to the correct pressure and are not damaged i.e. bad cuts or nailed.
- The electrical equipment that has been fitted should all work, i.e. lights, indicators, wipers, horns, reversing warning bleeper, etc. (A flashing amber light must be fitted to any vehicle that is to travel on a dual carriageway if its speed is less than 28 mph)
- The brakes must be in good working order. The hand brake must work and can be tested by trying to pull away or on an incline. Should brakes fail in any way the machine must be taken out of service until repairs have been carried out.
- Hydraulics must be tested to ensure that they are working correctly, first check for oil leaks by inspection of the system and pipes. (NB: no steel braid should show on any pipe). If check valves are fitted to the machine they must be tested regularly. This must be carried out in a safe area away from the works. The machine should be extended to the maximum and the engine cut off, the machine must not then move. Should there be any movement, the valves are not operating correctly and the machine must be taken out of service.

Use inspection reports to detail any failures and advise line / site manager.

Discussion Points

What do you think could happen if the inspection wasn't done?

Have you seen any defects that need reporting?